

SUMMARY

Transition Year student at Rath Dara Community College with a strong academic interest in biochemistry and herpetology. Demonstrated strong science and mathematical performance through secondary school. Pursuing a future career pathway in biological sciences, pharmacology, and toxinology.

SKILLS

- Problem Solving
- Teamwork and Collaboration
- Video Editing and digital content creation
- Communication
- Computer skills and basic coding (python)
- Organization and Time Management
- Willingness to learn
- Species identification and biological classification
- Calm under pressure
- Health and safety awareness

EXPERIENCES

INDEPENDENT REPTILE & VENOM RESEARCH

Personal Research Project | 2026

- Independent research into snake species, taxonomy, venom biology, and toxin composition.
- Developed knowledge of 75+ snake species, including classification and identifying characteristics.
- Researching potential applications for venom toxins in medicine.

TY Computer Science Programme

Rath Dara CC | 2026

- Selected to participate in a TY computer science programme
- Developing skills in Python, micro:bit and fundamental programming concepts.

Zain Arif

+353 89 979 0978
zainarif09@gmail.com

AREAS OF INTEREST & PROJECTS

Herpetology & Venom Biology

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Strong personal interest in the biological study of snakes and venomous reptiles. Developing knowledge through independent research into snake taxonomy, biogeography, and venom biology, with an interest in the potential medical applications of venom toxins.

Pharmaceutical Science & Biochemistry

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Strong interest in biochemistry, pharmacology, and pharmaceutical science, with an interest in how scientific knowledge is applied in healthcare. Seeking to gain practical insight into the pharmacy environment, patient-facing services, and the role of pharmacy professionals.

EDUCATION

Rath Dara Community College | Dublin

Junior Cycle - 2023-2026 - Currently in Transition Year (TY)

- For Junior Cycle Final Examination, achieved Distinctions in: Science, Geography, Math, Engineering and French with Higher Merit in Irish, Religion, English, History and Business Studies.

ACCOMPLISHMENTS AND AWARDS

Student of the Year (Consecutive Winner)

Awarded the top academic and character prize out of the entire year group for three consecutive years (1st, 2nd and 3rd) at Rath Dara Community College.

Attendance Awards

Received attendance awards in 1st, 2nd and 3rd year, with 0 absences recorded in 2nd year.

Golf Scholarship

Selected as a player to receive a fully funded club scholarship, including clubs, professional coaching and membership privileges until 18.

REFERENCES

Justyna Kolasinska - Science Teacher
Rath Dara Community College
justynakolasinska@rathdaracc.ie
Office Phone: (01) 820 1122

Sean Murphy - TY Coordinator
Rath Dara Community College
seanmurphy@rathdaracc.ie
Office Phone: (01) 820 1122